

Latex Template

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Question 1. *You just know the answer*

A common problem in QM is “find the energies of the following Hamiltonian.” The idea is to do as little math as possible but to build intuition. Describe the lowest several eigenenergies of the following Hamiltonians. It is up to you to decide what value of “several” best illustrates what is going on. Answers are short.

Example: What are the energies of the two separate simple harmonic oscillators, each with frequency ω ?

Answer: The oscillators have energies

$$E_1 = \hbar\omega(1/2 + n_1), \quad n_1 = [0, 1, 2, 3, \dots]$$

$$E_2 = \hbar\omega(1/2 + n_2), \quad n_2 = [0, 1, 2, 3, \dots]$$

so the combined oscillators have energy

$$E = E_1 + E_2 = \hbar\omega(1 + n_1 + n_2) = \hbar\omega[1, 2, 2, 3, 3, 3, 4, 4, 4, 4, \dots]$$

1. Particle of mass m in one dimensional box of width a .
2. Particle of mass m in two dimensional box of width a and length b .
3. Two disconnected particles, each of mass m , one in a 1D box of width a and the other in a 1D box of width b .
4. Particle of mass m confined to a circular ring of circumference a .
5. Particle of mass m in a one dimensional potential $V = \frac{1}{2}m\omega^2x^2$.
6. Particle of mass m in a two dimensional potential $V = \frac{1}{2}m\omega^2(x^2 + y^2)$.

Proof.

□

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Question 2. *Two-body to one-body* (Griffiths 5.1 in both editions)

Given my history, I will not transcribe these anymore unless I add something to it, but feel free to email if you need me to.

Proof.

□

Question 3. SHO in 3D (Modified Griffiths 3rd ed. 4.46, or 2nd ed. 4.39)

Consider a particle of mass m for which the potential is

$$V(r) = \frac{1}{2}m\omega^2 r^2$$

- (a) Using separation of variables in Cartesian coordinates, show that this factorizes into a sum of three 1D harmonic oscillators, and use your knowledge of 1D SHO to determine the allowed energies.
- (b) Determine the degeneracy $d(n)$ (i.e. the number of states with the same energy as the n th energy eigenvalue E_n).
- (c) As you hopefully found in part (b), the ground state $\psi_0(x, y, z)$ is non-degenerate. However the first excited energy eigenvalue E_1 is threefold degenerate, with eigenstates:

$$\psi_{1,0,0}(x, y, z) = \tilde{\psi}_1(x)\tilde{\psi}_0(y)\tilde{\psi}_0(z)$$

$$\psi_{0,1,0}(x, y, z) = \tilde{\psi}_0(x)\tilde{\psi}_1(y)\tilde{\psi}_0(z)$$

$$\psi_{0,0,1}(x, y, z) = \tilde{\psi}_0(x)\tilde{\psi}_0(y)\tilde{\psi}_1(z)$$

where $\tilde{\psi}_i$ denotes an eigenstate of the 1D harmonic oscillator. Are any of the linear combinations

$$\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}(\psi_{1,0,0} + \psi_{0,1,0} + \psi_{0,0,1}), \quad \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(\psi_{1,0,0} + \psi_{0,1,0}), \quad \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(\psi_{1,0,0} + i\psi_{0,0,1})$$

also energy eigenstates? In each case, why or why not?

Proof.

□

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Question 4. $1D$ to $3D$ (*Griffiths 4.1, same in both editions*)

Proof.

□

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Question 5. *Cubical well* (Griffiths 4.2, same in both editions)

Proof.

□

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Question 6. *Practice with Spherical Harmonics* (Griffiths 4.4 in 3rd edition, 4.3 in 2nd edition)

Proof.

□